

because the very juxtaposition of the implicit and the explicit may help us to make for ourselves a profitable comparison of the two religions. We cannot praise the older faith more highly than by showing how it contained seed-thoughts that in the light and warmth of Christian enthusiasm might have blossomed into beauty for all the world to admire. There is also another comment that will be in place after nearly every paragraph in the present exposition. We have seen that Judaism and Christianity have developed a series of fundamental ideas which can be recognised centuries before in the obscure phrases of the Gathas. But the difference of setting is so complete that we have not to argue against the perversely ingenious people who write as if there was a complete set of Sacred Books of the East in Aramaic on the shelves of a public library in Nazareth or Capernaum. One cannot, of course, predict what a Jensen or a Drews may say—*quibus est nihil negatum!* But for scholars in general there will, of course, be no thought of dependence in such a sphere as this; and the very fact that there may be such deep-seated affinity in religions which at least in these respects admittedly did not influence one another, may be remembered as a useful caution later on.

Pursuing my general comparative method, I proceed to point out a more recondite affinity than those I have been noticing. I have observed already that the Amshaspands are so markedly within the Divine hypostasis as not to allow the suggestion that Zarathushtra's own thought fell short of monotheism. There is a very real but by no means obvious parallel in the development of Early Christian